

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 679

By McCalmon

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend William Zabka.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly are pleased to recognize those individuals whose talents and dedication to the performing arts have left a lasting cultural legacy; and

WHEREAS, William Zabka, an esteemed actor and producer, has earned acclaim for his portrayal of Johnny Lawrence in *Cobra Kai*, the critically celebrated continuation of the iconic *Karate Kid* franchise; and

WHEREAS, reprising a role he first made famous in 1984, Mr. Zabka brought remarkable depth, humor, and humanity to the character of Johnny Lawrence, portraying him as a fully realized figure whose personal growth, struggles, and redemption resonated deeply with viewers of all ages; and

WHEREAS, throughout its run, *Cobra Kai* garnered numerous accolades, most notably the 2025 Saturn Award for Best Action/Thriller Television Series, a testament to the high quality of its production and the powerful performances of its cast, including that of William Zabka; and

WHEREAS, beyond its achievements in entertainment, *Cobra Kai* inspired renewed interest in the martial arts, encouraging a new generation to explore the disciplines of karate and self-defense, and instilling in audiences the timeless values of perseverance, discipline, and personal growth; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Zabka's contributions to the series, both as a leading actor and creative force, have helped reinvigorate a beloved story for contemporary audiences, offering themes of resilience, mentorship, and second chances; and

WHEREAS, it is wholly fitting that we should honor an artist whose work continues to resonate deeply across Tennessee and beyond; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor William Zabka for his outstanding contributions to television and the martial arts community, commend him for his pivotal role in the success of *Cobra Kai*, and extend to him our best wishes for much continued success in his future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.